

Where do y'all stand with ChatGPT and its environmental impact?

Posted by u/Honest_Detective817 • 0 points • 27 comments

Given all the water and electricity used to cool down the systems, where do you stand when people say to not use ChatGPT for its environmental impact?

Comments

u/dadabhai_naoraji • 1 points • 2025-04-24 07:35 UTC

I made a [Chrome Extension](<https://chromewebstore.google.com/detail/chatgpt-co2-tracker/hkjljphcfcpfjdknlpolgofpceebjpha>) for people to visualise their CO2 emissions and water usage while using ChatGPT - I'm hoping that being able to see environmental impact will help people be more judicious with their usage.

<https://preview.redd.it/oqxhkm3mkqwe1.png?width=1582&format=png&auto=webp&s=99a912c5071ec6eec8313d269da7cce8345ac134>

u/Wrong-Ad5755 • 2 points • 2025-01-14 02:07 UTC

Chat gpt caused the wildfires, in California, nobody is saying word about that

u/6411644334 • 1 points • 2025-01-14 00:04 UTC

Couldn't care less.

u/akmetal1 • 1 points • 2025-01-13 22:00 UTC

Many of the servers are in places where they have natural cooling (arctic environments) and substantial renewable energy resources. We shed tons of power from Hoover Dam, Niagara Falls etc. Many server farms are in places like Iceland with virtually unlimited geothermal.

u/2Drex • 1 points • 2025-01-13 21:39 UTC

Maybe this helps: [From Words to Watts: Benchmarking the Energy Costs of Large Language Model Inference](<https://arxiv.org/pdf/2310.03003>)

u/Jazzlike-Spare3425 • 2 points • 2025-01-13 21:29 UTC

So, ChatGPT is running on Azure servers and I believe Microsoft's goal is to become water-negative by 2023. They also want to be powering their Azure servers with 100% renewable energy by 2025. They are currently closer to 80% but I don't think I have to feel THAT guilty.

u/cinnamontoast-krunch • 1 points • 2025-01-13 21:20 UTC

Who cares. It helps me get through uni

u/Outrageous-Bonus50 • 1 points • 2025-01-13 21:19 UTC

Chatgpt is great for the environment. I save about 2 hrs a day NOT using the computer and other electronic devices. Makes me a lot more efficient for almost all aspects of life and business. We're talking about incredible environmental savings. The savings are far-reaching.

u/throwawaysusi • 1 points • 2025-01-13 21:18 UTC

Europeans malding because can't develop their own AI.

u/JebDipSpit • 1 points • 2025-01-13 21:16 UTC

realize it's a WAR then look how how many coal fired power plants some other countries have opened in this last year. Chat GPT is doing fine

u/leshiy19xx • 1 points • 2025-01-13 21:16 UTC

I recall reading two things:

1. The numbers are not that big, in comparison to other cloud stuff
2. Someone calculated co footprint a human has to paint a drawing and it is not better than AI's.

u/frankieflowerz • 2 points • 2025-01-13 21:12 UTC

Do you feel guilty about flying, because the exhaust from jet engines accounts for approximately 2.4% of global CO2 emissions? Not to mention the particulates...

Do you feel guilty about eating meat, etc

u/The-Operators-book • 8 points • 2025-01-13 21:12 UTC

There's roughly the same amount of water on earth now as there was when dinosaurs roamed the earth.

It's not oil, it just changes state.

Most of the water in your body passed through the urinary tract of dinosaur..

u/Honest_Detective817 • 1 points • 2025-01-13 21:15 UTC

that's what I was mainly wondering. Since they use water to cool the systems down, where does the water go after it's used?

u/Yrdinium • 2 points • 2025-01-13 21:26 UTC

Surely, this is bait.

u/The-Operators-book • 2 points • 2025-01-13 21:25 UTC

It just gets recycled either by us or the earth and it's climate system

u/MostlyPropagandaHere • 1 points • 2025-01-13 21:12 UTC

I ask ChatGPT how I can cut down trees fast as possible using the most electricity.

u/smirket • 1 points • 2025-01-13 21:11 UTC

All of the data centers in the US combined use 4% of total electric load. However, that's up from 2% a couple years ago. The water use is a concern, but I'm really trying to limit my cloud usage for privacy and autonomy reasons. Real local solutions are getting more feasible.

u/NibbleOnNector • 1 points • 2025-01-13 21:10 UTC

It's another way people excuse corporations while trying to place them blame on individuals

u/Positive_Average_446 • 3 points • 2025-01-13 21:10 UTC

What ChatGPT can do for environment, by educating, by proposing solutions and guiding political decisions, far outweighs the very little harm that its use does.

We just need to give it a bit more useful power and usage. Some countries already do.

u/K5gfPe7Dms0l6Xmb • 1 points • 2025-01-13 21:07 UTC

Honestly?

Pfft.

u/ConcentrateDeepTrans • 22 points • 2025-01-13 21:06 UTC

Ah yes, let's vilify ChatGPT while we scroll endlessly on TikTok, binge 4K Netflix series, and ship next-day Amazon packages halfway across the globe. The internet's backbone already consumes a staggering amount of energy, yet somehow this specific tool that helps people learn, communicate, and work more efficiently is the hill to die on?

If you're really worried about the environment, maybe start by reconsidering that video of your dog you uploaded in HD to every platform imaginable. Or better yet, unplug entirely and write your environmental concerns on recycled parchment by candlelight. I'll wait.

u/One-Bad-4395 • 1 points • 2025-01-15 00:13 UTC

When you find yourself comparing your product to 'literally every service's energy use' I'd take it as a sign to calm down

u/Fun_Description_7792 • 4 points • 2025-01-13 21:30 UTC

You forgot to mention Reddit

u/Honest_Detective817 • 2 points • 2025-01-13 21:08 UTC

clock it 🕒